

CHAPTER NINE

LISTINGS, VIEWINGS, AND STARTING YOUR SEARCH

You've prepared yourself in every way possible, but now it's time to actually go out and do what we've been talking about doing. If only it were as easy as handing someone money and—*poof*—you're a homeowner! Well, actually, you *are* just giving someone money for a house, but this is where things start to get complicated. (As if they haven't been complicated already, right?)

If you're unfamiliar with everything that goes into a home purchase, you might leave money on the table or even leave your interests in the home unprotected. The purpose of Part Three is to walk you through the practical side of the purchase and turn you into a confident homeowner with as few surprises as possible.

Your agent and your lender will be two great resources throughout this process. If at any point you're confused or overwhelmed, don't be afraid to ask one or both of them for guidance. They've executed home purchases time and time again, so they will likely have answers to any questions that may come up. (And besides, they're both making a lot of money off your decision to work with them—so they shouldn't be opposed to a stray question, or two, or twenty!)

SETTING UP LISTING ALERTS

You've found a lender, you've found an agent, and you're finally ready to start checking out properties. This is when the magic happens! After all that time spent researching and making lists, you get to set foot in real-life houses. You never know which house will be *the* one—it could be the very first one you look at, or it could materialize dozens of listings later.